SwampSphere

Every Gator to Every Opportunity

Aydan Barry · Bayla Hirsh · Keaton Bennett · Sarah Decowski · Jackson Kracht

University of Florida | Freshman Leadership Experience Final Project

THE PROBLEM

Scattered Information

Low Discoverability

Missed Opportunities

PROJECT DESCRIPTION

What is SwampSphere?

SwampSphere is a centralized digital platform designed to connect every UF student with the full spectrum of campus involvement — from student organizations and service opportunities to campus events, leadership roles, and academic engagement.

INVOLVEMENT TYPES

- Student Organizations
- Campus Events
- Service & Volunteering
- Leadership Roles
- Research Opportunities
- Academic Involvement
- Professional Development
- Advocacy & Clubs

TARGET AUDIENCE

PRIMARY

All UF Students

- Incoming Freshmen
- Transfer Students
- Upperclassmen

SECONDARY

Organizations & Departments

- Student Orgs
- CLAS / Engineering / Business
- Career Connections Center
- UF Preview
- Student Government (FLEX)

HOW IT WORKS

Key Features & Functionality

01

Filters

Filter events and activities by major/college, interest type, and availability. Every student sees what's relevant to them.

02

A Complete Database

Each listing includes a full description, location, time, organizer info, available spots, and direct online registration — all in one place.

03

Personal Agenda

Once registered, events appear in a personal agenda. Students can sync their schedule directly to their calendar app.

04

Capacity Tracking

Events display remaining spots in real-time. When max registration is reached, the event is marked full.

05

Platform Integration

Built as an extension of an existing UF website or a new dedicated web app — low friction adoption for the entire Gator community.

06

Promotion

Organizations and departments can post events, track registrations, and reach a targeted student audience actively seeking involvement.

PROJECT GOAL

To organize campus activities and events in a way that allows students to become intentionally involved.

KEY ACTIVITIES & COMPONENTS

Building SwampSphere

I

App Development

- Design user interface & experience
- Build filtering & recommendation engine
- Implement Calendar sync
- Develop organization dashboard
- Mobile-responsive web application

II

Data Categorization

- Compile and tag all UF orgs & events
- Create structure: major, college, type, level
- Onboard a connection with existing club software at UF
- Establish data maintenance pipeline
- Partner with UF IT and UF CS for data access

III

Campus Rollout

- Pilot with FLEX student cohort
- Soft launch via UF Preview (new students)
- Tabling & promotion across campus
- Training sessions for org leaders
- Feedback collection & iteration

Mockups

Good morning,
Albert

1 Holds
0 To-Do
2 Events Today

TUESDAY, FEB 24
POT2002 Introduction to Political Theory — WEIM 1084 — 11:45 AM – 12:35 PM
EVENT Mental Health Workshop — Reitz Union G230 — 1:00 PM – 2:15 PM

New: SwampSphere
Discover involvement opportunities tailored to your interests. Build your personalized campus agenda.
Get Started

Home | SwampSphere | Calendar | Profile

Tuesday, February 24, 2026
SwampSphere

Search clubs, events, and more

CLAS | Engineering | Business | Health

Mental Health Workshop
UF Counseling and Wellness Center
Tuesday, February 24 • 1:00 PM - 2:45 PM
Reitz Union G230
Interactive workshop on mental health advocacy, peer support, and campus resources. Learn how to start conversations about mental health and support your friends.
Spots Left: 5 — You're Registered

Mock Interview Night
UF Career Connections Center
Tuesday, February 24 • 6:00 PM - 8:00 PM
Reitz Union G315 and G320
Sign up to hold mock interview with professionals from various industries. Receive feedback on your resume, interview skills, and professional presence. Business casual attire required.
Spots Left: 35 — Register Now

Home | SwampSphere | Calendar | Profile

My Calendar

TUESDAY, FEB 24
POT2002 Introduction to Political Theory — WEIM 1084 — 11:45 AM – 12:35 PM
EVENT Mental Health Workshop — Reitz Union G230 — 1:00 PM – 2:15 PM

Feb 2026

Su	Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
1	2	3	4	5	6	7

Home | SwampSphere | Calendar | Profile

My Profile

Albert Gator
Political Science Major
Junior (Third Year)

YOUR CLASSES — SPRING 2026
POT2002 Introduction to Political Theory — WEIM 1084 — 11:45 AM – 12:35 PM
MAC2312 Analytic Geometry and Calculus 2 — NRN 1020 — 12:50 PM – 1:40 PM
ARC1101 Places and Spaces (Quest 1) — Reitz Union G230 — 1:55 PM – 2:45 PM
ENG1131 Writing Through Media — WEIM 1082 — 3:00 PM – 3:50 PM
ACG2021 Introduction to Financial Accounting — Online

Your Interests

Mental Health | Career Prep | Creative | Religion | Gaming | Volunteering | Foodies | Sustainability | Outdoors | Technology | Culture | Academic | Student Government | Mindfulness

Home | SwampSphere | Calendar | Profile

TIMELINE

Phase 1

Spring 2026

Planning & Development

- Define the platform
- Design the user interface
- Secure UF IT partnership
- Data aggregation begins
- Work with FLEX to beta test

Phase 2

Summer 2026

Testing

- Further beta testing with student volunteers
- Organization onboarding info
- Bug fixes and other refinement
- Feedback collection
- Final pre-production pass

Phase 3

Fall 2026

Campus Launch

- Full campus rollout
- Tabling & promotion events
- UF Preview integration
- Ongoing data maintenance
- Success metrics tracking begins

PARTNERSHIPS & LOGISTICS

Resources & Collaboration

KEY PARTNERS

- UF Student Activities & Involvement
- UF Preview (new student onboarding)
- Career Connections Center
- UF Information Technology (IT)
- Student Government (FLEX)

LOGISTICS OVERVIEW

Space / Room Needs
None — fully online platform

Estimated Attendance
All UF students

Materials & Equipment
Website, design tools, admin support

Budget
TBD

Promotion Strategy
Tabling events across campus

READY TO CONNECT

Every Gator to Every Opportunity

SwampSphere will transform how UF students discover, connect with, and commit to the campus opportunities that shape their Gator experience.

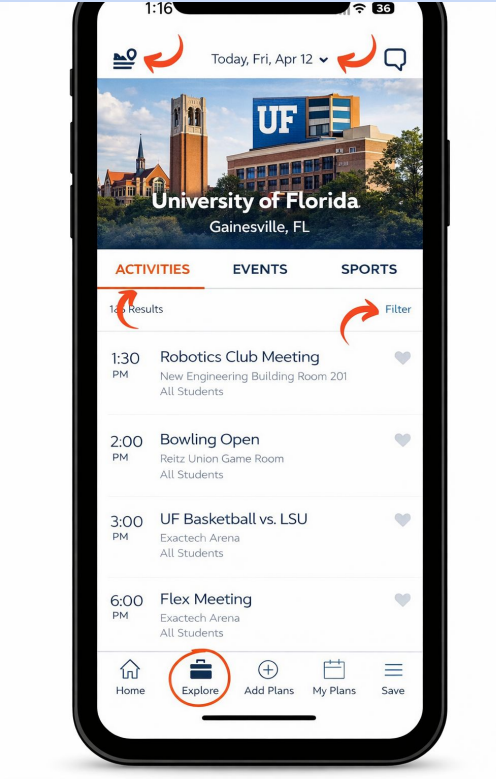
Aydan Barry · Bayla Hirsh · Keaton Bennett · Sarah Decowski · Jackson Kracht

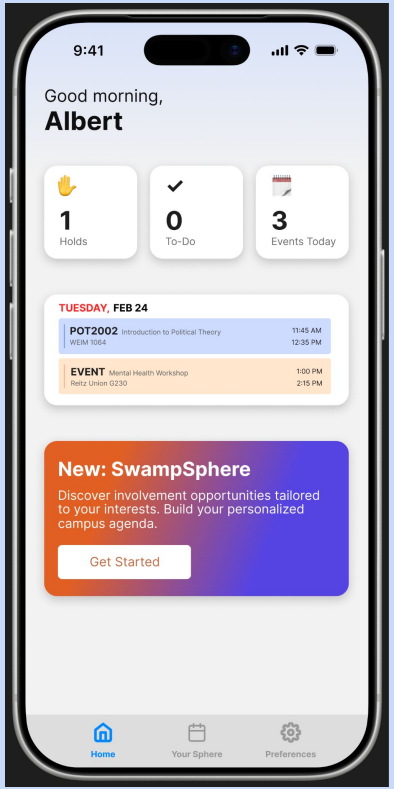
SwampSphere UF | FLEX Project Proposal | Spring 2026

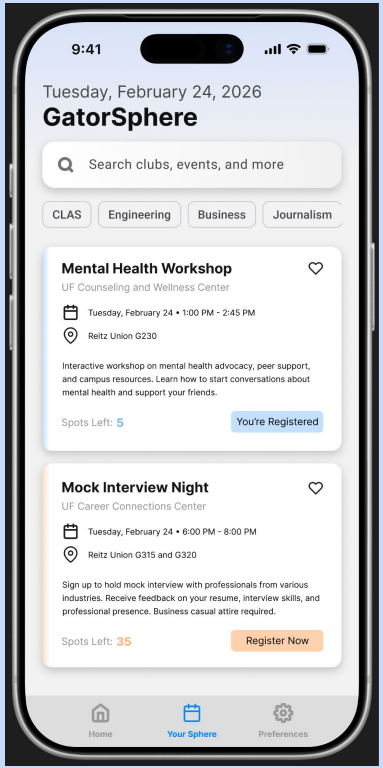
Flex Project Proposal

Aydan Barry, Bayla Hirsh, Keaton Bennett, Sarah Decowski, Jackson Kracht

SwampSphere







Project description

This is a centralized platform designed to connect students with everything happening on campus. From student organization and service opportunities to campus events, leadership roles, and academic involvement, the app provides access to ways students can engage with the Gator community.

The app answers common questions students ask daily:

“How did you know about that involvement opportunity”

“How can I become more involved”

Project goal and audience

-The goal of our app is to increase student engagement and having one accessible place where all students can go to gather information of UF involvement.

-The primary audience is all University of Florida students

- Incoming freshman, transfer students, and upperclassmen who are looking to get more involved on campus

- Secondary audiences include organization and departments that want to promote their events in increase participation

How the app works

-There will be an option to filter campus events/activities to best pertain to the interests of the user. Additionally, there would be a description of each activity online along with direct online registration. Once a student registers for an event, it will show up in their personal agenda, and students can have the option to sync Google calendar to the app to keep track of their involvement. If an event reaches maximum registration it will be shown

-The app will be an extension of an original UF app or a new app

Logistics

Planning and Development: Spring 2026 - Summer 2026

Testing: Fall 2026

Campus Launch: Spring 2027

Space or room needs: N/A

Estimated attendance: N/A

Materials and equipment needed: Website, design, support from student government and UF admin